

DJMP INSTITUTE

Transforming Untapped Potential Into Verified Talent

Summer STEM Program · Workforce Cybersecurity Track · Summer 2026

THE OPPORTUNITY WE CANNOT IGNORE

Chicago's South and West Side communities hold extraordinary talent. What they lack is access. Broadband adoption in majority-Black neighborhoods sits as low as 58%. African Americans represent just 8% of Chicago's tech workforce. With 92% of jobs requiring digital literacy, an entire generation of capable young people is being locked out of high-growth careers — not because of potential, but because the pathways don't exist.

DJMP Institute is building those pathways.

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literacy skills

WHAT WE OFFER

Two programs. One mission. Both seeking funding. Either is the proof of concept.

Both the Youth STEM Program and the Workforce Cybersecurity Track are seeking funding independently and running in parallel. Whichever secures funding first serves as the proof of concept. If both are funded, we will have simultaneous deployments validating the model across two populations and two program types.

YOUTH SUMMER STEM PROGRAM · Six Learning Labs · Grades 4–12

4 weeks (2-week minimum viable) · Mon–Fri · 9:00 AM–3:15 PM · 3 groups × 10 students = 30 total (hard cap)

Students rotate through a minimum of three Learning Labs — six available, age-differentiated, hands-on, deliverable-producing. Cybersecurity Lab available to Grades 11–12 (age 16+). Aviation Lab delivered 2x weekly by the Bessie Coleman Aviation All-Stars.



Robotics

FLL + FTC · Engineering ·
Programming



Cybersecurity

Grades 11–12 · Awareness · On-
ramp to workforce



AI

Machine learning · Ethics · Applied
tools



Game Design

Mechanics · UX · Coding · Final pitch



Aviation — Bessie Coleman All-Stars

Aeronautics · Drones · Flight simulation · Legacy



WORKFORCE CYBERSECURITY TRACK · Opportunity Youth & Returning Workers

12 months · Fortinet FCP Certification · Aligned to Advancing Workforce Mobility RFP

A separate, standalone skills-first cybersecurity pathway for opportunity youth (18+) and marginalized or displaced adults. Four phases — foundational networking through FCP certification and job placement. Seeks independent funding. Runs independently of the youth program.

This is not the summer cybersecurity Lab. The summer Lab is the on-ramp. This is the highway.

PROOF OF CONCEPT — PUSH EXCEL · RAINBOW PUSH COALITION

Push Excel — the educational arm of the Rainbow PUSH Coalition, founded in 1975 by Rev. Jesse L. Jackson, Sr. — has chosen the DJMP Institute Learning Lab model as the framework for their Summer STEM launch. A 50-year institution with national reach and U.S. Department of Education recognition validated what DJMP built.

That is not a partnership. That is a credential.

WHY DJMP INSTITUTE

Founded in Community

DJMP Institute was founded on work done at Rainbow PUSH — including the StaySafe App developed by the Push Excel tech team, unveiled at the 46th Annual Convention, featured in the Chicago Sun-Times and ABC7 Chicago.

Skills-First Model

Every Learning Lab produces student deliverables — not participation certificates. Funders can point to robots built, credentials earned, and games designed.

Proven Programs

Active curriculum in robotics, cybersecurity, AI, game design, and aviation. Workforce cybersecurity pathway submitted to a national RFP funder at the Demonstrate tier.

Scalable by Design

The summer program converts to Saturday and after-school models for Fall 2026. Push Excel is the first external deployment. The model is designed to go wherever the need exists.

FUNDING OPPORTUNITIES

Program Sponsor

Full summer program · Named recognition · Funder briefing + site visit

Learning Lab Sponsor

Sponsor a single Learning Lab · Named recognition · Impact reporting

Workforce Partner

Co-invest in the Workforce Cybersecurity Track · Employer engagement · Hiring pipeline access

In-Kind / Services

Technology, software licenses, venues, internship placements, expertise

The talent is already here. The pathways are what's missing.

DJMP Institute is building them — one Learning Lab, one group, one credential at a time.

djmpinstitute.org · Martin Pieters, Executive Director